

2005

The Year Of YouTube

February 15: YouTube...

In mid-February of 2005, a site went live. The idea was simple: allow everyday Net users to upload videos they create and allow them to share it with the world. Who knew! Today, YouTube is a phenomenon that's swept the world, and it's the fourth-most-popular site on the Net according to Alexa's traffic rankings. In true Web 2.0 style, YouTube brought the power of sharing and networking to the world, and did it with videos instead of vital stats.

April 25: XP Pro x64: no big deal

Microsoft released Windows XP Professional x64—the 64-bit version for those with 64-bit CPUs. The aim was to bring 64-bit computing into the mainstream, and take advantage of the higher performance and security that applications made for 64-bit have to offer. However, despite the fact that most of the computers sold in the past few years have been 64-bit capable, the lack of knowledge on the end-user's behalf and the dearth of true 64-bit applications out there haven't seen too much of a rise in the popularity of Windows XP Professional x64.

May 15: Adobe / Macromedia

Adobe completed its takeover of Macromedia, which it bought for an all-stock transaction of 3.4 billion dollars (Rs 13,600 crore). This made Adobe the largest creative design software company by far. With Adobe's own Acrobat, Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, Premiere, etc., and Macromedia's Dreamweaver, Flash, ColdFusion, etc., the new Adobe became a huge force in design and imaging software.

July 14: IBM and OS/2

IBM announced that OS/2 would officially be dead to them after December 23 the same year. It would only sell it till December 23, 2005, and support would actually end a week earlier on December 16, 2005. OS/2 had been around since 1987, made in collaboration between Microsoft and IBM until 1990, when IBM took over.